



FOR MORE
STORIES



REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE

juice can contain 22–25 grams of sugar with minimal fibre or satiety. Over time, this can cause unstable energy levels and slow metabolic function.

Athlete Tip: Don't replace meals with juices. Add protein or nut butters if consuming smoothies, and prioritise whole foods for optimal recovery and muscle maintenance.

Ryan's Rule: If it doesn't fuel your training or support recovery, it's not a meal — it's a missed opportunity.

Low-Carb Diets — Cutting Carbs Means Cutting Output

Many athletes are avoiding rice, rotis, and fruits, thinking carbohydrates are the enemy. But for physically active individuals, carbs are the primary fuel for brain and muscle function.

Whole grains, legumes, fruits, and millets provide fibre, antioxidants, and other essential micronutrients like magnesium and potassium. A study in the *Journal of Nutrition* showed that low-carb diets are associated with higher rates of nutrient deficiencies.

Athlete Tip: Use complex carbs to fuel training, especially 60 to 90 minutes before activity. This improves stamina and focus.

Ryan's Rule: Don't cut carbs; instead, clean them up. Choose quality over quantity, and time them around your workouts.

OMAD — One Meal a Day or One Big Mistake?

The OMAD (One Meal A Day) approach is gaining popularity among fitness influencers and 'biohackers'. But for serious athletes, eating once a day can disrupt

metabolism, impair digestion, and reduce nutrient absorption.

Large, single meals make it difficult for the body to efficiently absorb nutrients and maintain a consistent energy level throughout the day. Athletes risk losing lean muscle mass and feeling fatigued.

Athlete Tip: Aim for three balanced meals and two performance-based snacks per day to ensure constant nutrient delivery.

Ryan's Rule: Performance is built through consistency in training, recovery, and nutrition. One massive meal a day does not support any of these pillars.

Final Thoughts: Performance Over Popularity

As athletes, your body is your engine, your temple, and your tool. Trendy diets may look promising online, but sustainable performance comes from science-backed habits, not shortcuts.

Real wins are not measured by a weight scale, but by a strong finish, injury-free sessions, and consistent energy levels. That only happens when you fuel right — not when you follow what's trending.

Choose a real strategy over a social media strategy. Choose performance over popularity. And most importantly, choose what helps you recover faster, train harder, and compete stronger.

